在学校

马小山的第一天

At School

Ma Xiaoshan's first day

Text and translation by Claude (Anthropic)

Footnotes mark names and words above HSK 1 (HSK 3.0 lists: github.com/ivankra/hsk30, MIT).

1 今天是九月一号，星期一。这是马小山[†]在新学校的第一天。早上七点，妈妈叫他起床。小山[‡]在床上说：“妈妈，我不想去。新学校没有我的朋友。”妈妈说：“你去了，就有新朋友了。”“什么时候？”“今天！”

第一天

2 七点五十分，小山和妈妈到了学校。学校很大，有三个教学楼。小山的班在二楼。老师在门口等他。她笑着说：“你是马小山吗？你好！”

3 班里有三十个学生，他们都在看小山。小山不说话，也不笑。老师说：“小山，你坐在那儿，高文[§]的旁边。”

† 马小山 *Mǎ Xiǎoshān* Ma Xiaoshan
‡ 小山 *Xiǎoshān* Xiaoshan (Ma Xiaoshan)
§ 高文 *Gāo Wén* Gao Wen

Today is the first of September, a Monday. It is Ma Xiaoshan's first day at his new school. At seven in the morning, Mum called him to get up. Xiaoshan said from his bed, "Mum, I don't want to go. I don't have any friends at the new school." Mum said, "Once you go, you'll have new friends." "When?" "Today!" 1

The First Day

At ten to eight, Xiaoshan and his mother arrived at the school. The school was big, with three classroom buildings. Xiaoshan's class was on the second floor. The teacher was waiting for him at the door. She smiled and said, "Are you Ma Xiaoshan? Hello!" 2

There were thirty pupils in the class, and they were all looking at Xiaoshan. Xiaoshan didn't speak, and he didn't smile. The teacher said, "Xiaoshan, sit over there, next to Gao Wen." 3

上课

4 八点，上课了，是汉语课。老师在前边写汉字，学生们在看，也在写。高文[†]在写字，也在看小山[‡]的本子。“你的字真好看！”高文说。小山笑了。这是他今天第一次笑。

5 九点四十五分，下课了。高文问：“你喜欢打球吗？”“喜欢！”“我们什么时候去打球？”“中午吃了饭就去！”

6 十二点，他们在学校吃午饭。有米饭，有肉，也有鸡蛋。十二点半，他们在教学楼后边打球。小山有新朋友了。

† 高文 *Gāo Wén* Gao Wen

‡ 小山 *Xiǎoshān* Xiaoshan (Ma Xiaoshan)

In Class

At eight o'clock, class began. It was Chinese. The teacher was writing characters at the front, and the pupils were watching and writing too. Gao Wen was writing, and he was also looking at Xiaoshan's notebook. "Your handwriting is really nice!" said Gao Wen. Xiaoshan smiled. It was the first time he had smiled all day. 4

At a quarter to ten, the lesson ended. Gao Wen asked, "Do you like playing ball?" "Yes!" "When shall we go and play?" "Right after lunch!" 5

At twelve, they had lunch at school. There was rice, meat and eggs. At half past twelve, they were playing ball behind the classroom building. Xiaoshan had a new friend. 6

放学了

7 下午四点半，放学了。妈妈在学校门口等小山[†]。“今天在学校好玩儿吗？”小山说了很多：几点上汉语课，几点下课，中午吃了什么，和高文[‡]在哪儿打球……

8 晚上九点，妈妈说：“小山，睡觉了。”小山马上去睡觉了。他说：“明天七点半，高文在学校门口等我。”“妈妈，我明天什么时候起床？六点，好吗？”妈妈笑了。早上，小山不想去学校。现在，他想早一点儿去！

† 小山 *Xiǎoshān* Xiaoshan (Ma Xiaoshan)　‡ 高文 *Gāo Wén* Gao Wen

After School

At half past four, school was out. Mum was waiting for Xiaoshan at the 7
school gate. "Was school fun today?" Xiaoshan talked and talked: what time Chinese class started, what time it ended, what he'd had for lunch, where he and Gao Wen had played ball...

At nine in the evening, Mum said, "Xiaoshan, bedtime." Xiaoshan went to 8
bed straight away. He said, "Tomorrow at half past seven, Gao Wen is meeting me at the school gate." "Mum, what time should I get up tomorrow? Six o'clock, OK?" Mum laughed. That morning, Xiaoshan hadn't wanted to go to school. Now he wanted to get there early!